Topic 16 — Essentials: Awards, Personalities & GI Tags

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Bharat Ratna (भारत रत्न) (Culture) | Sangeet Natak Akademi (संगीत नाटक अकादेमी) Awards | Lalit Kala (ललित कला) Akademi (ललित कला अकादेमी) Awards | Sahitya (साहित्य) Akademi (साहित्य अकादेमी) Awards | GI Tags Related to Art & Culture | Important Cultural Personalities

Sources: Ministry of Culture, three Akademis, GI Registry (DPIIT), UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Last verified:** August 2026

Current Affairs

- Sahitya Akademi **Yuva Puraskar (युवा पुरस्कार) 2025** ran in **23** languages. **Dogri** was not on the list.
- The **58th Jnanpith (ज्ञानपीठ)** went to **Rambhadracharya** (Sanskrit), in a cycle shared with Gulzar. The prize began in **1965**.
- The **2025** Padma (पद्मा) Vibhushan (पद्म विभूषण) in Art went to **L. Subramaniam**.
- In **June 2026** the Sangeet Natak Akademi announced Fellowships and Awards for **2024** and **2025**.

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UKPCS Prelims 2025

Q. UKPCS Prelims 2025, Q53

Who among the following received the Padma Shri Award in 2025 for social work from Uttarakhand (उत्तराखंड)?

A. Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch B. Dr. Madhuri Barthwal C. Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt D. Shri Hugh and Colleen Gantzer (posthumously)

Show answer

Logic: Field of the award — social work vs folk (लोक) music. **Ans: C (Series B provisional key).** Radha Bahin Bhatt (Lakshmi Ashram, Kausani) — social work. Madhuri Barthwal is the folk-music distractor.

Q. UKPCS Prelims 2025, Q49

Which one of the following books is NOT written by Pushpesh Pant, a noted author of Uttarakhand?

A. From the King's Table to Street Food B. Victory Mantra: The Leader's Path to Success C. Himalaya (हिमालय) Ke Barf (हिमालय के बर्फ) D. Lazzatnama (लज़्ज़तनामा)

Show answer

Logic: Cuisine / food-history author — Series B keys option C as not his. **Ans: C (Series B provisional key).** Keyed title not by him is **Himalaya Ke Barf** (हिमालय के बर्फ). Follow Series B letter for this paper.

16.1 Bharat Ratna (Culture)

The Bharat Ratna is the highest civilian honour. It was instituted in **1954**. The Prime Minister recommends names to the President.

- Bharat Ratna sits above Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan and Padma Shri.
- It began for art, literature, science and public service. It later covers any field of human endeavour.
- There is no application form. Posthumous conferment is allowed.
- **M. S. Subbulakshmi** received it in **1998**. She is the **first musician** Bharat Ratna. The form is Carnatic vocal.
- **Pandit Ravi Shankar** received it in **1999**. The instrument is **sitar**.
- **Lata Mangeshkar** and **Ustad Bismillah Khan** received it together in **2001**.
- Bismillah Khan's instrument is **shehnai**. The living centre is **Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश).
- **Pandit Bhimsen Joshi** received it in **2008**. The form is Hindustani (हिंदुस्तानी) khayal (ख्याल) (Kirana (किराना)).
- **Bhupen Hazarika** received it in **2019** (posthumous). Assamese music and film.
- **Pandit Jasraj** received it in **2020** (posthumous). Mewati vocal.
- **Satyajit Ray** received the Bharat Ratna in **1992** for his monumental contributions to world cinema (not as a musical vocalist).
- **Dr Zakir Husain** (Bharat Ratna **1963**) was the educationist who became President. **Ustad Zakir Hussain** the tabla maestro is **not** a Bharat Ratna.
- **Pandit Birju Maharaj** is Padma Vibhushan and SNA Ratna. He is **not** Bharat Ratna.
- **Rabindranath Tagore won the** Nobel Prize in 1913**. He died in** 1941**, before Bharat Ratna existed.

> **Logic:** First musician BR = Subbulakshmi 1998. Bismillah = shehnai + 2001 + Varanasi**. Tabla Zakir ≠ 1963 BR.

16.2 Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards

Sangeet Natak Akademi awards cover performing arts. The Akademi was founded in **1952** (Act **1959**). It sits under Culture at Rabindra Bhavan.

- SNA honours **music, dance and theatre**, including folk and tribal (आदिवासी) forms.
- The **Akademi Award (Puraskar)** is the annual prize by discipline.
- **Akademi Ratna (Fellowship)** is the highest SNA honour. Living Fellows are capped near **40** (raised from 30). It is **not** a five-person club.

- **Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar** is SNA's youth performing-arts prize. It is **not** Sahitya Yuva Puraskar.
- HQ is **Rabindra Bhavan**, Mandi (मंडी) House, with Sahitya and Lalit Kala. Ministry is **Culture**.
- SNA is **1952**. Do not date it **1954**.
- **Rukmini Devi Arundale** is an SNA Ratna-level Bharatanatyam (भरतनाट्यम्) name.
- **Birju Maharaj** is an SNA Ratna-level Kathak name.
- **Balasaraswati** is an SNA Ratna-level Bharatanatyam name.
- **Kelucharan Mohapatra** is an SNA Ratna-level Odissi (ओडिसी) name.
- **Ebrahim Alkazi** is an SNA Ratna-level theatre-direction name.
- An artist may hold SNA honours and a Padma or Bharat Ratna. The bodies are different.

> **Logic:** SNA = 1952. Bismillah Khan Yuva = SNA**, not Sahitya.

16.3 Lalit Kala Akademi Awards

Lalit Kala Akademi awards cover visual and fine arts. The Akademi dates to **1954**. It sits under Culture and has a regional centre at Lucknow.

- Lalit Kala covers painting, sculpture, graphics and related visual practice. It does **not** give the Sahitya book prize.
- The annual prize is the **National Award**. The lifetime honour is **Fellowship (Kala Ratna)**.
- **Triennale India** is LKA's international exhibition. NGMA does not run it.
- **NGMA** is a **gallery** of modern art (Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru). Lalit Kala is an **academy**.
- The UP regional centre is at **Lucknow**.
- Same founding year as Sahitya Akademi: **1954**. Not 1952.

> **Logic:** Lalit Kala = visual, 1954. Lucknow** is the UP centre. Literature = Sahitya.

16.4 Sahitya Akademi Awards

Sahitya Akademi is the National Academy of Letters. It dates to **1954**. Awards run in **24** languages. Yuva Puraskar is for writers of **35** and under.

- The Sahitya Akademi Award is one best book per recognised language in a cycle.
- **Fellowship (Akademi Ratna)** is the highest Sahitya honour.
- **Yuva Puraskar** is for authors aged **35 or below** on the relevant date.
- **Bal Sahitya Puraskar** is children's literature.
- There is also a Translation Prize.
- The 24 languages are the **22 Eighth Schedule** languages plus **English** and **Rajasthani**.
- **Bhojpuri** is **not** a separate Sahitya Akademi recognised language.

- **Jnanpith** is **not** a Sahitya Akademi prize. The trust is **Bharatiya Jnanpith**. The first award was **1965** (**G. Sankara Kurup**, Malayalam).
- The **58th Jnanpith** was conferred on **Jagadguru Rambhadracharya** (Sanskrit). **Gulzar** shared that cycle. The statement "conferred upon Rambhadracharya" is still true.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q20

With reference to Sahitya Akademi Yuva Puraskar announced in June 2025, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Yuva Puraskar was announced in 23 Indian languages.
2. There is no Yuva Puraskar in Dogri this year.

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

Show answer

Ans: C — Both 1 and 2. Official note: 23 writers; no award in Dogri. President then: **Madhav Kaushik**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q148

With reference to Jnanpith Award, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The 58th Jnanpith Award was conferred upon Sanskrit scholar Jagadguru Rambhadracharya Ji.
2. The first Jnanpith Award was given in 1965.

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

Show answer

Ans: C — Both 1 and 2. Jnanpith ≠ Sahitya Akademi. First winner = G. Sankara Kurup.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q76

Who is the author of the novel **"All the Lives We Never Lived"**, which received the Sahitya Akademi Award 2022?

A. Anita Desai (आमिल) B. Anuradha Roy C. Shobha De D. Sudha Murthy

Show answer

Ans: B — Anuradha Roy (English).

> **Logic:** Sahitya Yuva covers **23** languages with **no Dogri** slot. **Jnanpith** began in **1965** — not the Sahitya Akademi year. Sahitya Akademi awards **24** languages, not **22**.

16.5 GI Tags Related to Art & Culture

A GI tag is a place-name plus a traditional quality. The ministry is **Commerce (DPIIT)**. It is not a Culture-ministry tag.

- A GI protects a cultural product's **geographic name**. Banarasi Brocade cannot be used as a free brand by outsiders.
- The law is the **GI of Goods Act, 1999**. The **Registry is at Chennai**.
- Nodal ministry is **Commerce and Industry (DPIIT)**. It is **not** Culture and **not** Textiles.
- The **first** Indian GI is **Darjeeling Tea (2004)**. It is not Banarasi saree.
- Validity is **10 years**, renewable. The owner is a **community**, not one company (कंपनी). That is why GI ≠ trademark.
- **Banarasi Brocade** is a Varanasi GI.
- **Chikankari** (चिकनकारी) is a Lucknow GI.
- **Bhadohi carpet** is a UP GI.
- **Moradabad metalware** is a UP GI.
- **Khurja pottery** is a UP GI.
- **Firozabad glass** is a UP GI.
- **Kannauj (कन्नौज) attar** is a UP GI.
- **Mathura (मथुरा) Sanjhi (सांझी)** is a UP GI.
- **Madhubani** (मधुबनी) painting GI belongs to **Bihar**.
- **Warli** (वारली) painting GI belongs to **Maharashtra**.
- **Pattachitra** (पट्टचित्र) painting GI belongs to **Odisha** (ओडिशा).
- **Kalamkari** (कलमकारी) painting GI belongs to **Andhra Pradesh**.
- **Blue Pottery of Jaipur** is Rajasthan, not Lucknow.

> **Logic:** GI = Commerce, Chennai. First = Darjeeling Tea 2004. Banarasi + Chikan = Uttar Pradesh.

16.6 Important Cultural Personalities

For personalities, learn form, person, honour, and place together. One wrong pair loses the match.

- **Bismillah Khan** plays **shehnai**. Varanasi. Bharat Ratna **2001**.
- **Birju Maharaj** is **Kathak** (Lucknow gharana (घराना)). Born UP. Not Bharat Ratna.
- **Ravi Shankar** plays **sitar**. Bharat Ratna **1999**.
- **Bhimsen Joshi** is Hindustani vocal. Bharat Ratna **2008**.
- **MS Subbulakshmi** (एम.एस.) is Carnatic vocal. Not playback.
- **Lata Mangeshkar** is playback. Bharat Ratna **2001**.
- **Ustad Zakir Hussain** is **tabla**. Padma awards and Grammys. **Not** Bharat Ratna. He died in **December 2024**.
- **Rukmini Devi Arundale** revived Bharatanatyam and founded **Kalakshetra**.

- **Kelucharan Mohapatra** is Odissi.
- **Yamini Krishnamurthy** is Bharatanatyam / Kuchipudi (कुचिपुड़ी). She died **3 August 2024**.
- **Munshi Premchand** (Lamhi, Varanasi, UP) is the preeminent pioneer of modern Hindi-Urdu realist fiction (*Godan*, *Gaban*).
- **Tulsidas** (तुलसीदास) wrote *Ramcharitmanas* in Awadhi.
- **Rambhadracharya** is the Sanskrit Jnanpith name in the 2025 paper.
- **Anuradha Roy** wrote *All the Lives We Never Lived* (Sahitya Akademi English, 2022).
- **Satyajit Ray** is cinema Bharat Ratna **1992**.
- **Raja (राजा) Ravi Varma (रवि वर्मा)** is the oleograph-realism painter.
- **Nandalal Bose** is the Bengal School (बंगाल स्कूल) painter.
- **Amrita Sher-Gil** is celebrated as the pioneer of modern Indian visual art, blending European post-impressionist techniques with Indian traditional subjects.
- **Tansen** (तानसेन) is Akbar (अकबर)'s (अकबर) court dhrupad (ध्रुपद) name.
- **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो) (born at Patiyali, Kasganj, UP) is revered as the father of qawwali (क़व्वाली), developer of Khari Boli/Hindavi poetry, and innovator of Hindustani musical forms.
- Padma Vibhushan **2025** in **Art** went to **L. Subramaniam** (violin).
- Padma Vibhushan **2025** in Literature and Education went to **M. T. Vasudevan Nair**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q96

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below.

List-I (Field) A. Trade (पण्याध्यक्ष) and Industry B. Literature and Education C. Medicine D. Art

List-II (Awardee, 2025) 1. Shri Lakshminarayanan Subramaniam 2. Shri Osamu Suzuki 3. Shri M. T. Vasudevan Nair 4. Shri D. Nageshwar Reddy

A. 3 2 1 4 B. 2 3 4 1 C. 2 3 1 4 D. 3 2 4 1

Show answer

Ans: B. A-2 Suzuki, B-3 MT Vasudevan Nair, C-4 Reddy, D-1 L. Subramaniam (Art).

> **Logic:** Bismillah = shehnai. Birju = Kathak, not BR. Tabla Zakir ≠ BR 1963**.
